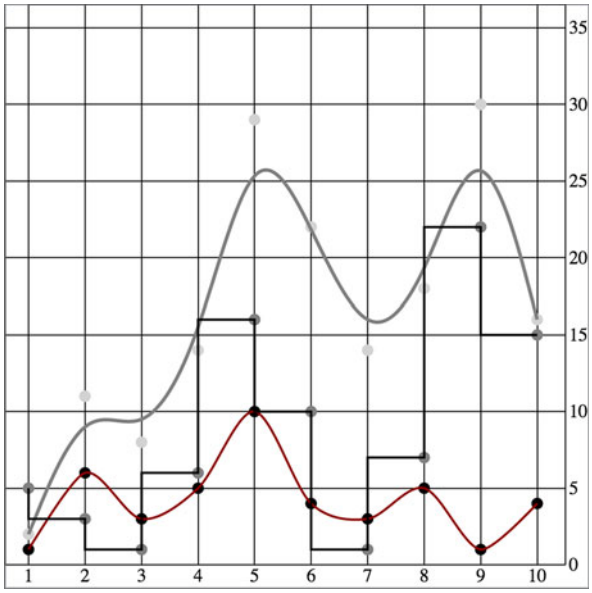


Figure 4.20 Light gray: "basis" interpolation; dark gray: "step" interpolation; black: "cardinal" interpolation

4.5 Complex accessor functions

All of the previous chart types we built were based on points. The scatterplot is points on a grid, the boxplot consists of complex graphical objects in place of points, and line charts use points as the basis for drawing a line. In this and earlier chapters, we've dealt with rather staid examples of information visualization that we might easily create in any traditional spreadsheet. But you didn't get into this business to make Excel charts. You want to wow your audience with beautiful data, win awards for your aesthetic *je ne sais quoi*, and evoke deep emotional responses with your representation of change over time. You want to make streamgraphs like the one in figure 4.21.

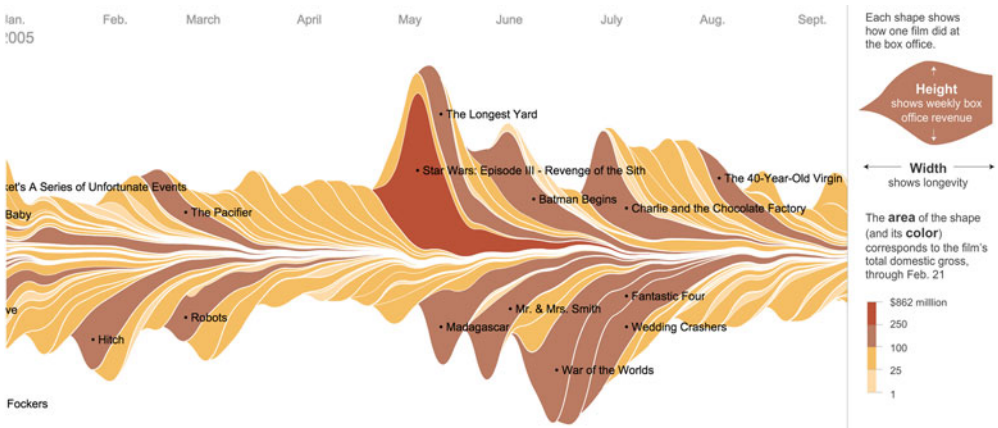


Figure 4.21 Behold the glory of the streamgraph. Look on my works, ye mighty, and despair! (figure from *The New York Times*, February 23, 2008; http://mng.bz/rV7M)